

Tunisia



Area 63,170 sq miles
(163,610 sq km)
Population 10.6 million
Capital Tunis
Currency Tunisian dinar
Official language Arabic
Life expectancy 74 years



North Africa's smallest country, Tunisia lies sandwiched between Libya and Algeria. Its population is almost entirely Muslim, of Arab and Berber descent, though there are Jewish and Christian minorities. Tourism is an important sector of Tunisia's economy.

Libya



Area 679,362 sq miles
(1,759,540 sq km)
Population 6.4 million
Capital Tripoli
Currency Libyan dinar
Official language Arabic
Life expectancy 74 years



Libya is located in North Africa, between Egypt and Algeria. In 2011, a civil war ended Colonel Muammar al-Gaddafi's 42 years of dictatorial rule. Libya is now headed by its newly elected parliament, the General National Congress.

Niger



Area 489,191 sq miles
(1,267,000 sq km)
Population 16.1 million
Capital Niamey
Currency CFA franc
Official language French
Life expectancy 56 years



Landlocked in the west of Africa, Niger is covered by the Sahara Desert in the north. It has large deposits of uranium, which is its main export. Niger is one of the poorest countries in Africa and faces regular food shortages. It is highly dependent on aid.

Egypt



Area 386,662 sq miles
(1,001,450 sq km)
Population 82.5 million
Capital Cairo
Currency Egyptian pound
Official language Arabic
Life expectancy 71 years



Egypt occupies the northeast corner of Africa. The highly fertile Nile valley separates the arid western desert from the smaller, semiarid eastern desert. Most Egyptians speak Arabic, and many speak French or English as a

second language. Egypt's capital, Cairo, is the second most populous city in Africa and its population is predicted to reach 100 million by 2025. In addition to oil and gas, Egypt's economy is also dependent on agriculture (especially cotton) and its well-developed tourist industry. Egyptian women have been among the most liberated in the Arab world, and enjoy more rights under the law than women in many other Arab nations. However, growing Islamic fundamentalism in the country is seen as a possible threat to their position, especially in the rural areas.

▼ ANCIENT MONUMENTS

The Great Sphinx—a human-headed lion—is set against the towering pyramid of Khafre in the desert region of Giza, Egypt.

